

The FlowCode Mental Game Plan

Mushin (無心) through a trained routine — Fudoshin (不動心) under fire

The system in one line: the routine is the gate, Fudoshin is the vehicle, “cloud / sky” is the reset. Thoughts and bad results are clouds; your awareness is the sky. You don’t fight the cloud — you remember you’re the sky.

1. Your mental bag: two clubs always in hand, one club you choose

Think of every technique as a club in your bag. You’d never hit a single shot trying to use five clubs at once — and the same is true here. **You don’t empty the bag onto one shot; you select the one club the moment calls for.**

Two clubs are always in your hands, on every shot, and you’ve owned them for years:

- **The image** — a very small target, ideally just behind your real target, locked from the moment you step behind the ball all the way through the swing.
- **Physiological control** — breath and tension, monitored and corrected with your own methods.

These run constantly underneath everything. They’re mastered — but like any club, they stay sharp only with reps, so they stay in your practice rotation even though they no longer need a prompt.

The third lever is the cue — the single thing you *add* to crack the door to Mushin. And here’s the rule your range session proved in real time: **one cue at a time, never two.** A second cue is swinging two clubs at once — it clutters the mind and kills the shot. The clinic’s “*breath + image + cue*” is right as the three lever *types*, and “*one lever rarely works alone*” simply means the cue rides on top of your image-and-breath foundation. It never means stack cues on cues.

So why carry a whole bag if you only use one cue? Two reasons: you pick the *right* cue for the moment, and you keep backups — some days the window opens you up, some days gratitude does. The bag is your options, not your checklist.

2. Your pre-shot routine: image + breath + one cue

Always running (both phases): your locked image, and your breath-and-tension control. Everything below is built on top of those two constants.

BUILD-UP — behind the ball. Image locked, breath settled. Add **one** cue to open toward Mushin. The cues that work for you here — pick a single one:

- a **window** — see the ball fly through an invisible window in the air
- **soft focus** — expanded, relaxed awareness
- **gratefulness**
- **something that makes you happy**

GAIN — walking in and setting up. Image still locked, physiology controlled, and your single tempo practice swing (part of your routine for years). Then **one** cue to quiet the mind — pick a single one:

- a **laser** from clubface to your target
- **positive thinking / an affirmation** (“I’m ready and capable”)
- **growing a plant** — nurturing it by banking your good shots

PEAK — the trigger. Eyes to your locked target, and go on your own tempo. Nothing to add here. The quiet you’ve built carries the swing. That’s Mushin — you only notice afterward how clear it was.

TRANSITION — after. Curious, not judgmental. One neutral observation — a fact, never a verdict. *The cloud doesn’t change the sky.* Learn one thing, release, walk forward in anticipation.

Bring the **hero-shot attitude to every shot** — full commitment, real energy into the process (*“compete for every shot”*) — but stay **detached from where it lands**. Energy to the process, detachment from the outcome. That’s the paradox Fudoshin lets you hold.

3. The five nodes you asked me to own

You said train the front of the loop and it drives the back — *“we can train 1-4 and it’ll affect 5-8.”* That’s your leverage. Nail entry, and the swing and the bounce-back take care of themselves.

Node 1 — FOCUS (*“flow follows focus”*)

- **The skill:** narrow external focus on one *specific* target. Not “the fairway” — *that* branch, *that* patch of grass.

- **Your tools:** laser, window, target-ball-swing. All visual — your strength.
- **Drill:** before every range ball, name your target out loud and make it as small as you can. The smaller and more specific the target, the quieter the mind. Specificity *is* the off-switch for chatter.

Node 2 — THOUGHT (*Ken's node*)

- **The skill:** notice the monkey without wrestling it. You can't control the first thought; you own the second. This is the node you work with Ken — his coaching here stands, and this plan rides alongside it, not over it.

Node 3 — EMOTION (*"energy in motion" — Fudoshin*)

- **The skill:** regulate arousal, don't eliminate it. Your note: "*Fear → quickness, tense. Calmness saves.*" Tension wants to control the clubface; calm lets it release.
- **Your tools:** gratitude (flips state instantly), the long exhale (down-regulates), "*I am ready and capable*" (confidence).
- **Drill:** rate your arousal 1–10 before each shot. Above a 6, add one extra slow exhale before you step in. You're learning to *feel* your state and adjust it on command.

Node 4 — STATE — the crucial one (*"get into the zone: anchor, visualize, breathwork"*)

- **The skill:** drop into the zone reliably via your trained stack. This is the engine. You said it's the crucial node and you're right — it's the gate to Mushin.
- **Your tools:** the full stack in §2.
- **Train it:** make the sequence *fixed and automatic*. Same order, same words, every time, until you're not deciding to do it — it just runs.

Nodes 7 & 8 — POST-SHOT and RESPONSE

- **Node 7 — post-shot routine:** one neutral observation, release. Every ball, no exceptions.
- **Node 8 — between-shot reset:** step back, soft focus, one breath, then start a *full fresh routine*. Treat each ball as one shot on the course. This single habit transfers more to your scores than any swing change. And remember — no one can touch nodes 1 and 2. Focus and Thought are fully internal and yours, which is why they're your reset levers.

4. Driver range protocol

Driver is the right club to train this on: the urge to control and kill it is strongest, so letting go pays the most here.

Quality over volume. ~25-30 driver balls with the full routine, not 100 rake-and-hits. Calibration warm-up is informal — don't log it.

Block 1 — Routine reps (10-12 balls). Full routine: image locked, physiology controlled, **one** cue per phase, real small target and window. Treat each as a tee shot on a hole you know. Want data? Run a short sub-block on each behind-the-ball cue (window, then soft focus, then gratefulness) and watch your Mushin ratings — that tells you which cue is opening you up *today*.

Block 2 — Pressure sim (6-8 balls). Real stakes: fairway or it doesn't count. Miss one and you owe the **Circle Drill**. One cue, hold the discipline, hole the next one.

The Circle Drill — your consequence. 8 putts in a row from 3 feet, set in a full circle around the hole. Every putt must drop. Miss a single one and the whole circle starts over — it is not finished until all 8 are holed consecutively. It's a pressure cooker by design: by putt 7 or 8 the cost of a miss is the entire restart, which is exactly the Fudoshin you're training — stay present, stay unmoved, hole the next one.

Every ball, both ways: post-shot routine (Node 7 — one neutral observation, release) and a between-shot reset (Node 8 — step back, soft focus, breathe, re-approach).

Track the process, not the ball. Two marks per shot in the tracker: did I run the full routine (Y/N), and Mushin at impact (1-5). Ignore where it landed.

5. The arc to scratch (now → August)

Straight with you: 4-5 to scratch in two months is aggressive. But you were near 3 last year, so the ball-striking is *there* — this is about reliably *accessing* it under pressure, which is what the mental game unlocks. *"The mental game is trainable, but it's a skill that must be developed through practice."* Treat scratch as the direction; judge yourself on process, and the number follows.

Weeks 1-2 — Groove the routine. Image + breath + one cue, same every time, low pressure. Find your strongest cue for each phase (Block 1's data tells you). *Metric: % of shots with the full routine.*

Weeks 3-4 — Pressure-proof + transfer. Make the Circle Drill your standing range consequence. Play practice rounds running the whole loop. Hold the post-shot and between-shot discipline on the course. *Metric: routine holds under on-course pressure; reset quality after bad shots.*

Weeks 5-6 — Competitive sim. Rounds that “count” (track score, judge process). Tighten cue selection — fewer, more reliable. *Metric: Mushin average trending up under score pressure.*

Weeks 7-8 — Tournament application. Nothing new. Run the trained system in competition; judge only the process goals. *Metric: routine %, reset quality, and the two tracker numbers — the score follows them.*

*See it, feel yourself, quiet the mind, and let it go. **The cloud doesn't change the sky.***